

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 788

By Martin G

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize Gary Jared on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to honor those individuals who have answered a divine call to the ministry and have served with dedication, vigor, and enthusiasm to perform God's work for their congregations and communities; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Gary Jared, senior pastor of Stuart Heights Baptist Church, who took his much-deserved retirement on December 31, 2025, following thirty-five years of devout service in that role; and

WHEREAS, Gary Jared has been an influential figure in religious ministry and always followed the direction of the good Lord; he delivered his final sermon as senior pastor of Stuart Heights Baptist Church on Sunday, December 28, 2025; and

WHEREAS, under his astute leadership as pastor, Stuart Heights Baptist Church grew from one location and approximately two dozen members to three locations and 1,000 members and hosted the Easter at Coolidge Program for fifteen years; and

WHEREAS, during his retirement, Pastor Jared plans to remain an active member of Stuart Heights Baptist Church and will serve as pastor emeritus; and

WHEREAS, he earned a bachelor's degree, a seminary degree, and an honorary doctorate degree from Temple University; and

WHEREAS, his professional accomplishments aside, Pastor Jared is a family-oriented and selfless gentleman, who is most grateful for the love and support of his beloved wife, Nancy, their four daughters, and several cherished grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Gary Jared has continued to demonstrate excellence in his calling as a man of God; the members of his congregation have been proud to call him their pastor, leader, and friend; and

WHEREAS, a true shepherd of the flock, Gary Jared has an abiding love for the ministry; his many contributions to his church, his community, and this State are deeply appreciated, and it is wholly fitting that he be recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Gary Jared on the occasion of his retirement, thank him for his meritorious service as senior pastor of Stuart Heights Baptist Church, and extend to him our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.